

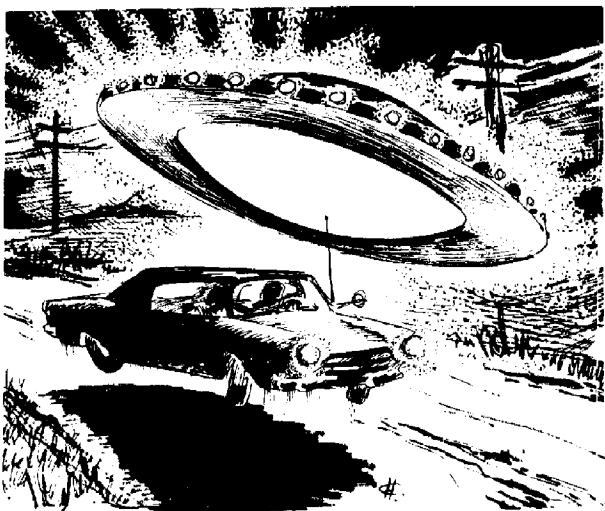
(Since the letter was unsigned, we could not find out further particulars of this incident, such as the date and whether the witness saw the vehicle depart. While this may make the whole account doubtful, it should be noted that the area in question experienced a rash of sightings in 1965-67 -- HCH.)

"Thank you for putting on the symposium and I feel if people knew more about this perhaps they wouldn't be as scared as I was at the time."

A point of interest: the southeastern part of Oklahoma is a scenic part of the state with the beautiful Kiamichi Mountains and the Quachita National Forest, where in 1960 one of the most interesting UFO cases reported to the Bureau came from Stigler.

Mrs. Maxine Hayes and Mrs. Barbara Lewis were driving their car from Stigler enroute home when they observed a silver-looking object at very close range. As the UFO got closer to them, *they noticed that their car was being lifted about 18 inches off the road*, and being moved over to the left side.

"The object descended, looking at first like a star with a streak of light", reported Mrs. Hayes. "But then we saw it resembled a silver saucer, with revolving lights around the middle of its round-shaped body. It got slower the nearer it got to earth, and the nearer we got to it. Then suddenly it started pulling our car to the left side of the highway. It seemed we were floating on our tires. I couldn't do anything to move the car myself but the speedometer registered up to 110 miles an hour, so I took my foot off the accelerator. Then the car seemed to drop back on the highway.



"When this happened the object was 12 to 18 feet above a tree, which was near a telephone pole. It didn't budge at first but then it started to move slowly away, I'd say at about 20 miles per hour. It had some sort of legs out and when it went down behind the trees, it lit up the trees on both sides of the field. The most beautiful lights I have ever seen. The place was about three miles from the tower of McCurtain -- there's an old coal mine there -- where it landed. And that's the last we saw of it."

Mrs. Hayes told Bureau officials the time was, "about one hour before dark. The sky was clear and a few stars were already out." Describing the UFO further, she stated, "It started to fall like a star, only it wasn't a star at all.

"I know it sounds impossible, but I really saw this object."

Five years later and only a few miles from Stigler on July 26, 1965, five persons observed a UFO at Hartshorne, Oklahoma. Mrs. Altaclair Morgan told Bureau officials "the UFO sat hovering over the trees just about 500 feet from our home." Bureau investigators in a nationally publicized field investigation found after close scrutiny of the area, that in all, 104 residents admitted sighting a UFO in a nine-month period. Tape interviews were made of the testimony of 28 of the witnesses, including the chief of police and the Hartshorne postmaster. In some instances UFO's were sighted at tree-top level and flashing red lights.

Six years later on September 4, 1971, R.J. Rankin was to observe a UFO landing in his field. "I lay down and looked out and saw a peculiar light. Then, as it got closer, I saw that it wasn't a plane. It appeared like a round object, then the thing came down in this open field. I jumped up, told my wife as I headed for the front room, 'Look out there! What is that thing?' We ran outside as the thing took off. My wife said, 'That's a funny looking thing!'"

By this time the UFO was approximately 10 feet off the ground and going up.

Speaking to International UFO Bureau investigators standing where the craft landed, Rankin said, "I don't have any idea what it was then, and I don't know now." He estimated the craft to be intelligently controlled as it landed softly. "It didn't come down hard enough to leave any tracks.

"It was a glowing light at first. It looked bluish-red and had places in it all the way around it that looked like windows."

Rankin estimated the craft to be approximately 8-10 feet in diameter and about four feet high. "It was on the ground maybe 15 - 20 seconds. It

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